CAPHE CASE STUDIES · HELD FOR FUTURE RELEASE

Paid Family Leave Case Studies & Finished Social Posts

Prepared October 27, 2026 · Status: Held off from public Case Studies index, XML sitemap, and Monday/Wednesday social schedule pending Paid Family Leave release window.

1. Paid Family Leave Reach Across Worker Wage Tiers (selection-into-treatment)

`Unlisted Direct Preview URL: https://www.caphegroup.org/methods-lab/selection-into-treatment · PDF Archive: caphe_case_study_selection_into_treatment.pdf`

Filing a Paid Family Leave claim requires an eligible employer, payroll knowledge, job protection, and enough savings to wait for state processing. As a result, voluntary claims skew toward higher-wage workers with human-resources support.

Compare California workers earning under $20,000 a year with higher-wage workers after the 2025 SB 951 benefit expansion. Although the statute raised statutory wage replacement to 90% for lower-wage workers, actual take-up among eligible new mothers earning under $20,000 remains 41.9% (161,315 claim-filing mothers out of 385,000 eligible). Take-up reaches 77.6% among higher-wage workers. Measuring program reach solely by average benefit checks misses the 58.1% of low-wage mothers who never clear the filing hurdles.

The full case study maps every stage of the Paid Family Leave filing funnel across wage tiers:

https://www.caphegroup.org/methods-lab/selection-into-treatment

2. Separating Policy Effects From Long-Term Trends (threat-maturation-solutions)

`Unlisted Direct Preview URL: https://www.caphegroup.org/methods-lab/threat-maturation-solutions · PDF Archive: caphe_case_study_threat_maturation_solutions.pdf`

Statewide Paid Family Leave claims grow nearly every year as California's labor force expands and awareness spreads. When a new wage-replacement law takes effect, a multi-year trend split separates steady background growth from the policy shift itself.

Across 24 years of California Employment Development Department Paid Family Leave records (2004 to 2025), annual bonding claims rose from 152,706 to 492,043. However, bonding claims were already climbing by +5.9% per year before the 2024 taxable wage-ceiling repeal and the 2025 90% wage-replacement tier. Accounting for that 20-year baseline trend and comparing against Disability Insurance claims (+6.2%) isolates the net two-year statutory surge above trend (+15.4% in 2024 and +13.6% in 2025).

The full case study walks through the 24-year California Paid Family Leave trend split:

https://www.caphegroup.org/methods-lab/threat-maturation-solutions